SYNTHETIC – FOR RESEARCH AND TESTING ONLY

Sardar Patel Institute of Technology (SPIT)
Academic Year 2026–27

Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules

Office of the Dean of Student Affairs

Field	Details
Document ID	SPIT-CA-COC-2026-01
Document Title	Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules
Issuing Department	Office of the Dean of Student Affairs
Approving Authority	Governing Body, on the recommendation of the Academic Council (meeting dated 30 May 2026)
Version	3.0
Publication Date	1 June 2026
Effective Date	1 July 2026
Supersedes	SPIT-CA-COC-2024-01 (Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules, Version 2.1, effective 1 July 2024)
Applicable To	All students of the institute (UG, PG, PhD), on campus, in hostels, during institute-related activities off campus, and in online spaces connected with the institute
Next Review Date	31 May 2027
Category	Campus and Administration
Keywords	code of conduct, discipline, misconduct, Category A, Category B, Category C, penalty, fine, suspension, rustication, expulsion, ragging, anti-ragging, Disciplinary Committee, show cause notice, hearing, appeal, Appellate Authority, identity card, substance abuse, cyber conduct

Disclaimer. This is a fictional, synthetic document created solely to test a retrieval-augmented College Information Chatbot (research prototype). It does not represent, reproduce or summarise any actual policy of Sardar Patel Institute of Technology. All names, figures, dates, contact details and procedures are invented.

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 This Code sets the standards of conduct expected of every student of Sardar Patel Institute of Technology and lays down the procedure for dealing with misconduct. Its aim is to protect the safety, dignity and academic freedom of all members of the institute, and to ensure that disciplinary action is fair, consistent and proportionate.

1.2 The Code applies to conduct:

- on the institute campus, including hostels, the library, laboratories, sports facilities and the canteen;
- during institute-related activities off campus, including industrial visits, internships arranged by the institute, competitions, festivals, treks and club events;
- in online spaces connected with the institute, including institute e-mail, learning management systems, the Student Portal, and class, club or hostel messaging groups;
- off campus and online where the conduct affects the safety or rights of another student or seriously harms the institute's reputation.

1.3 Misconduct during examinations (use of unfair means, impersonation, possession of unauthorised material in the examination hall) is dealt with under the Examination Rules and Regulations and not under this Code, except where the conduct also involves violence, threats or damage to property.

1.4 This version (3.0) replaces the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules, Version 2.1 (SPIT-CA-COC-2024-01). The principal changes are listed in Section 12.

2. Definitions

2.1 **Working day** means any day from Monday to Saturday except the second and fourth Saturdays, Sundays and public holidays declared by the institute. The same definition is used in the Student Grievance Redressal Policy (SPIT-CA-GRV-2026-01).

2.2 **Misconduct** means any act or omission by a student that breaches this Code or any other rule of the institute, including the Library Rules and Regulations (SPIT-CA-LIB-2026-01), the Hostel Rules and Regulations (SPIT-CA-HST-2026-01) and the Student Clubs and Societies Handbook (SPIT-CA-CLB-2026-01), where that rule refers the matter to this Code.

2.3 **Disciplinary Committee (DC)** means the committee constituted under Section 7.3.

2.4 **Rustication** means removal of a student from the institute for a specified period (one or more semesters), after which the student may resume studies. **Expulsion** means permanent removal of a student from the institute.

3. General Standards of Conduct

3.1 Every student is expected to:

- treat fellow students, faculty, staff and visitors with courtesy and respect, irrespective of caste, religion, gender, disability, region, language or economic background;
- carry the institute RFID identity card at all times on campus and show it when asked by any faculty member, officer or security staff;
- comply with reasonable instructions given by faculty, officers, wardens and security staff in the course of their duties;
- use institute property, equipment and resources responsibly and only for authorised purposes;
- maintain academic integrity in assignments, projects and research, as set out in the institute's academic regulations;
- follow the safety instructions applicable to laboratories, workshops and events;
- keep their contact details, including the parent or guardian's contact details, up to date on the Student Portal.

3.2 **Dress.** Students must dress decently and appropriately for an academic institution. Students must wear the prescribed safety gear (laboratory coat, closed footwear, safety glasses) in laboratories and workshops.

3.3 **Smoking, alcohol and drugs.** The campus is a tobacco-free, alcohol-free and drug-free zone. Smoking or use of tobacco products and e-cigarettes is prohibited everywhere on campus.

3.4 **Vehicles.** Students may park two-wheelers and four-wheelers only in the designated student parking areas, with a valid parking sticker issued by the Security Office. Rash driving on campus, riding without a helmet and parking in fire lanes are prohibited.

3.5 **Digital conduct.** Students must not use institute networks or accounts to access or distribute unlawful or obscene material, attempt unauthorised access to any system, share their login credentials, or impersonate another person. Students must not record, photograph or publish images or recordings of any other person in a classroom, hostel or private setting without consent, or of a lecture without the faculty member's permission.

3.6 **Media and public statements.** Students may not speak to the media or post statements on behalf of the institute without the authorisation of the Director or the Registrar.

4. Categories of Misconduct

4.1 Misconduct is classified into three categories according to its seriousness. The examples below are illustrative and not exhaustive; the disciplinary authority decides the category of misconduct not listed, by comparison with these examples.

Category	Seriousness	Examples
Category A – Minor	Breaches that cause minor disruption and no harm to persons	Failure to carry or show the identity card; smoking on campus (first instance); littering or defacing walls with posters; misuse of classroom or laboratory furniture without damage; parking in an unauthorised area; disruptive behaviour in class or the library after a warning; minor breach of event conditions by a participant
Category B – Major	Breaches that cause harm, significant disruption, or damage to property, or repeated Category A misconduct	Third or subsequent Category A misconduct within one academic year; use of abusive or threatening language; possession or consumption of alcohol on campus or in the hostel; theft or deliberate mutilation of library material or institute property; damage to property exceeding ₹5,000; tampering with fire-safety equipment; misuse of another person's identity card; lending one's identity card to another person for entry; unauthorised night-out or sub-letting referred under the Hostel Rules and Regulations; posting defamatory or harassing content about a student or staff member online; retaliation against a student for filing a grievance; filing a deliberately false or malicious complaint; organising an unapproved event using the institute's name
Category C – Grave	Breaches that endanger safety, involve serious violence or dishonesty, or violate the law	Ragging in any form; physical assault; sexual harassment (after a finding by the Internal Complaints Committee); possession, consumption or supply of narcotic or psychotropic substances; possession of weapons or explosives; forgery of institute documents, certificates or signatures; misappropriation of club or institute funds; unauthorised access to institute computer systems or data; any act that is a criminal offence under the law and is connected with the institute; repeated Category B misconduct

5. Penalties

5.1 The penalties that may be imposed for each category of misconduct are given below. One or more penalties may be imposed together, and the authority must choose a penalty proportionate to the misconduct, taking into account the student's previous record, the harm caused and any mitigating circumstances.

Category	Penalties that may be imposed	Authority that may impose
Category A	Verbal or written warning; fine up to ₹2,000; community service on campus up to 10 hours; written apology; recovery of the cost of any damage	Head of Department, Warden (for hostel matters), Librarian (for library matters) or the Dean of Student Affairs
Category B	Fine from ₹2,001 to ₹10,000; community service up to 40 hours; suspension from classes, hostel or club activities for up to 30 days; withholding of the character certificate for a specified period; debarment from holding office in any club or the Student Council for up to two years; cancellation of hostel allotment; recovery of the cost of any damage	Disciplinary Committee
Category C	Fine up to ₹25,000; suspension for more than 30 days; rustication for one to four semesters; expulsion; withholding of results or degree; cancellation of admission; permanent debarment from hostel and from all student offices; lodging of a First Information Report (FIR) with the police where required by law	Disciplinary Committee (all penalties); expulsion and cancellation of admission require the approval of the Director

5.2 **Recording.** Category A penalties are recorded in the student's disciplinary record and removed one year after the penalty is imposed if there is no further misconduct. Category B and Category C penalties remain on the record and are mentioned in the character certificate.

5.3 **Fines** are paid through the "Disciplinary Dues" option of the Student Portal within 15 working days of the decision. Unpaid fines are carried forward as institute dues and must be cleared before the release of the grade card for the semester.

5.4 **Parents.** The parent or guardian is informed in writing of every Category B or Category C penalty, and of every Category A penalty imposed on a student below 18 years of age.

5.5 **Effect on student positions.** A student under a Category B or Category C penalty is not eligible to hold office in a club or the Student Council, as provided in the Student Clubs and Societies Handbook, nor to receive priority in hostel allotment.

6. Ragging

6.1 **Zero tolerance.** Ragging is prohibited inside and outside the campus. Ragging is always a Category C offence. The institute follows the applicable UGC regulations on curbing the menace of ragging in higher educational institutions.

6.2 **What ragging includes.** Ragging means any conduct by a student or students, whether by words spoken or written or by any act, that has the effect of teasing, treating or handling with rudeness a fresher or any other student; or that causes or is likely to cause annoyance, hardship, physical or psychological harm, or fear or apprehension in a fresher or any other student; or that asks a student to do any act that the student would not ordinarily do and that causes shame, torment or embarrassment. It includes:

- verbal abuse, insults or comments about a student's appearance, background, region, caste or language;
- forcing a student to perform tasks, run errands, sing, dance or perform any act against the student's will;
- physical abuse, sexual abuse, forced consumption of any substance, or confinement;
- financial extortion or forcing a student to pay for others;
- isolating or excluding a student, or online ragging through messaging groups and social media.

6.3 **Committees.** The institute constitutes the following for 2026–27:

Body	Composition	Role
Anti-Ragging Committee	Director (Chairperson), Dean of Student Affairs, Chief Warden, two faculty members, a representative of the local police, a representative of the local media, a representative of a non-governmental organisation working with youth, a parent representative, a senior student and a fresher representative	Ensures compliance with anti-ragging regulations and decides penalties on the report of the Anti-Ragging Squad
Anti-Ragging Squad	Seven faculty and staff members nominated by the Director, at least two of whom are women	Conducts surprise checks in hostels, canteens, buses and other places; investigates complaints on the spot
Mentoring Cell	One faculty mentor for every 20 first-year students, and one senior student mentor for every 10 first-year students	Supports freshers through the first year

6.4 **Reporting.** A student who is ragged, or who witnesses ragging, should report it immediately to any member of the Anti-Ragging Committee or Squad, the Warden, the Dean of Student Affairs, the security desk, through an anonymous Safe Report on the Student Grievance Portal, or through the national anti-ragging helpline. Failure to report ragging that one has witnessed, or encouraging or abetting ragging, is itself treated as participation in ragging.

6.5 **Procedure for ragging complaints.** On receiving a complaint, the Anti-Ragging Squad conducts an inquiry and submits its report to the Anti-Ragging Committee within **7 days**. Where the complaint discloses a criminal offence, the Director, or a person authorised by the Director, lodges an FIR with the police within **24 hours** of receiving the complaint. The Anti-Ragging Committee decides the penalty after giving the accused student a hearing.

6.6 **Penalties for ragging.** Depending on the nature and gravity of the ragging, one or more of the following penalties are imposed: suspension from classes and academic privileges; withholding or cancellation of scholarship or other benefits; debarring from appearing in any test or examination; withholding of results; debarring from representing the institute in any event; suspension or expulsion from the hostel; cancellation of admission; rustication for one to four semesters; expulsion and debarment from admission to any other institution for a specified period; fine up to ₹25,000. Where the persons who committed ragging cannot be identified, the institute may impose collective punishment on the group suspected of being involved.

6.7 **Undertakings.** Every student and the student's parent or guardian must submit the online anti-ragging undertaking at the time of admission and at the beginning of each academic year. Hostel residents submit it again at the time of reporting to the hostel, as required by the Hostel Rules and Regulations.

7. Disciplinary Authorities

7.1 **Category A matters** are decided by the Head of Department (for misconduct in academic areas), the Warden (for hostel matters), the Librarian (for library matters) or the Dean of Student Affairs (for all other matters). The authority may decide the matter summarily after hearing the student orally and recording the decision on the Student Portal.

7.2 **Referral.** An authority dealing with a Category A matter that it considers more serious must refer the matter to the Dean of Student Affairs, who decides whether it is to be placed before the Disciplinary Committee.

7.3 **Disciplinary Committee (DC).** Category B and Category C matters (other than ragging, which is decided by the Anti-Ragging Committee, and sexual harassment, which is inquired into by the Internal Complaints Committee) are decided by the Disciplinary Committee, constituted as follows:

Member	Role
Dean of Student Affairs	Chairperson
Chief Warden	Member
Three senior faculty members nominated by the Director, at least one of whom is a woman	Members
Head of the Department to which the student belongs, or nominee	Member (for that case only)
Assistant Registrar (Student Section)	Member-Secretary (non-voting)

7.4 The quorum for a DC meeting is four members including the Chairperson. A member who is a complainant or witness in a case, or who is related to the student, does not take part in that case.

7.5 **Interim suspension.** Where the continued presence of a student on campus or in the hostel is likely to endanger any person or interfere with the inquiry, the Dean of Student Affairs may suspend the student from classes or the hostel, pending the decision of the DC, for up to **15 working days**. This period may be extended only by the Director. Interim suspension is not a penalty; if the student is found not guilty, the student is given an opportunity to make up the academic work missed.

8. Procedure for Category B and Category C Matters

8.1 **Complaint.** Any member of the institute may make a complaint of misconduct in writing to the Dean of Student Affairs, or through the Student Grievance Portal. Wardens, the Librarian, the Student Activities Cell and Heads of Department refer matters under their respective rules in the same way.

8.2 **Preliminary inquiry.** Within **5 working days** of receiving a complaint, the Dean of Student Affairs, or a faculty member nominated by the Dean, conducts a preliminary inquiry to decide whether there is a case to answer. If there is no case to answer, the complaint is closed and the complainant is informed.

8.3 **Show cause notice.** If there is a case to answer, the Member-Secretary issues a show cause notice to the student through the Student Portal and institute e-mail, stating the allegations, the category of misconduct alleged and the evidence relied upon. The student must submit a written reply within **5 working days** of the notice.

8.4 **Hearing.** The DC holds a hearing with at least **3 working days'** notice to the student. At the hearing:

- the student may present a defence, produce documents and call witnesses;
- the student may be accompanied by a parent, guardian or faculty member, but may not be represented by a lawyer;
- the student may question witnesses through the Chairperson;
- if the student fails to attend without sufficient reason, the DC may proceed in the student's absence.

8.5 **Decision.** The DC decides whether the misconduct is proved on the balance of probabilities and, if so, the penalty. The decision, with reasons, is communicated to the student in writing within **5 working days** of the hearing. The entire process, from receipt of the complaint to the decision, should be completed within **30 working days** wherever possible.

8.6 **Confidentiality.** Disciplinary proceedings are confidential. The names of students penalised are not published, except that the institute may publish a general notice of the penalty imposed for ragging without identifying the student, as a deterrent.

9. Students' Rights in Disciplinary Proceedings

9.1 Every student against whom proceedings are initiated has the right to be informed of the allegations in writing, to see the evidence relied upon, to a reasonable opportunity to reply and be heard, to a decision by an authority free from bias, to receive a reasoned decision, and to appeal.

9.2 A student under inquiry may continue to attend classes and examinations unless placed under interim suspension under Section 7.5.

10. Appeals

10.1 The table below sets out the appeal routes.

Decision appealed against	Appellate authority	Time limit to appeal	Time for decision
Category A penalty imposed by a Head of Department, Warden or Librarian	Dean of Student Affairs	7 working days from the decision	10 working days
Category A penalty imposed by the Dean of Student Affairs	Director	7 working days from the decision	10 working days
Penalty imposed by the Disciplinary Committee or the Anti-Ragging Committee	Director (Appellate Authority)	15 working days from the decision	20 working days
Expulsion or cancellation of admission	Appeals Committee of the Governing Body	15 working days from the decision	30 working days

10.2 An appeal is filed through the "Disciplinary Appeal" form on the Student Portal or in writing to the Office of the Director, and must set out the grounds of appeal. Grounds may include a failure of procedure, new evidence that could not have been produced earlier, or a penalty that is disproportionate.

10.3 The appellate authority may confirm, reduce or set aside the penalty, or send the matter back for a fresh hearing. The appellate authority may not increase the penalty. The decision of the appellate authority is final within the institute.

10.4 Filing an appeal does not stay the penalty, except a fine, which is not collected until the appeal is decided. The appellate authority may stay a suspension or rustication pending the appeal if it considers it just.

10.5 Appeals against disciplinary decisions are not filed under the Student Grievance Redressal Policy.

11. Good Conduct and Character Certificate

11.1 A character certificate is issued by the Registrar on request at the time of leaving the institute. It states "good" conduct if the student has no Category B or Category C penalty on record, and otherwise mentions the penalty and the year in which it was imposed.

11.2 A student with a Category B penalty may apply to the Dean of Student Affairs, after two years of good conduct following the penalty, for the penalty not to be mentioned in the character certificate. The Dean decides on the application on the recommendation of the Disciplinary Committee.

12. Changes from the Previous Version

12.1 This version (3.0) supersedes SPIT-CA-COC-2024-01 (Version 2.1). The principal changes are:

Provision	Previous version 2.1 (2024–25)	This version 3.0 (2026–27)
Classification of misconduct	Two categories (Minor and Major)	Three categories (A – Minor, B – Major, C – Grave)
Maximum fine	₹10,000 for any misconduct	₹2,000 (A), ₹10,000 (B), ₹25,000 (C)

Provision	Previous version 2.1 (2024–25)	This version 3.0 (2026–27)
Online conduct	Not expressly covered	Covered, including messaging groups and social media (Sections 1.2 and 3.5)
Reply to show cause notice	7 working days	5 working days
Overall time for DC decision	No time limit	30 working days wherever possible
Interim suspension	Up to 30 days by the Dean of Student Affairs	Up to 15 working days by the Dean; extension only by the Director
Appeal against DC decisions	To the Director within 30 days	To the Director within 15 working days; expulsion appeals to the Appeals Committee of the Governing Body
Removal of minor penalties from record	Not provided	Category A penalties removed after one year without further misconduct
Anonymous reporting of ragging	Not provided	Safe Report through the Student Grievance Portal
Retaliation against complainants	Not expressly covered	Category B misconduct

12.2 Misconduct committed before 1 July 2026 is dealt with under the procedure in this version, but the penalty may not exceed the penalty that could have been imposed under Version 2.1.

13. Contact

Purpose	Contact
Dean of Student Affairs (complaints of misconduct, interim suspension)	Room A-102, Administrative Block; dsa@spit.example; extension 2100
Disciplinary Committee (Member-Secretary)	Student Section, Room A-108, Administrative Block; discipline@spit.example; extension 2108
Anti-Ragging Squad (24 hours)	antiragging@spit.example; security desk extension 2399
Internal Complaints Committee	icc@spit.example; extension 2115
Office of the Director (appeals)	Room A-201, Administrative Block; director.office@spit.example; extension 2001